



WASHINGTON MYSTICS

SHAKIRA AUSTIN | Career Performance Brief

Career through July 16, 2026 | C | 6'5" | Age 25 | No. 3 pick, 2022



EXECUTIVE READ

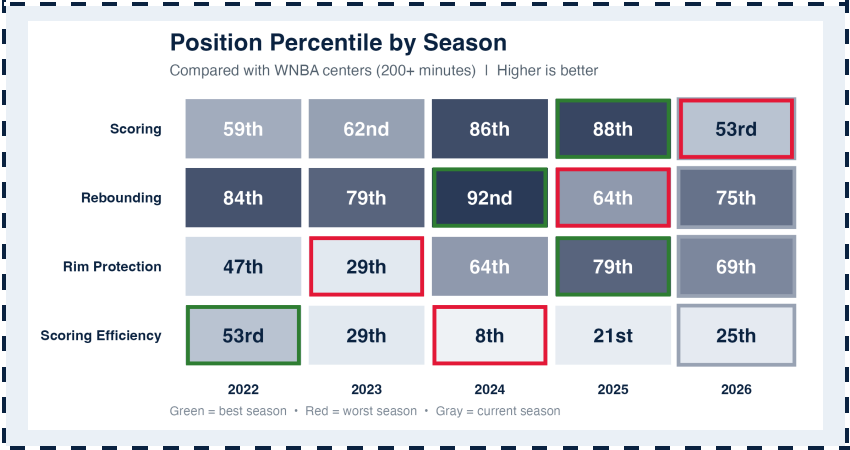
Shakira Austin profiles today as a complementary starting center whose rebounding, rim protection and paint pressure create two-way value when she is deployed as a finisher rather than a primary creator. Washington should retain and support her with guard creation and perimeter spacing; her path to becoming a dependable two-way starter hinges on improving scoring efficiency and possession management while sustaining her recent availability.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

PTS / 36 17.4 73rd percentile +5.2%	REB / 36 10.8 73rd percentile +1.4%	BLK / 36 1.6 60th percentile +7.3%	TRUE SHOOTING 52.6% 27th percentile -2.0%	AVAILABILITY 69.2% 35th percentile -1.2%
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Percentiles relative to Centers only | Average YoY growth

PERFORMANCE TRAJECTORY / CAREER-TO-DATE



PLAYER PROFILE

WINNING TRAITS

Interior Production: 17.4 PTS/36 and 10.8 REB/36, both 73rd %tile among centers.

Paint Pressure: Her 41.8% free-throw attempt rate ranks in the 85th %tile.

Defensive Activity: 1.38 STL/36 ranks in the 85th %tile. Her rim-protection %tile moved from 29th in 2023 to 79th in 2025 and 69th in 2026.

PRIMARY CONSTRAINTS

Efficiency: 52.6% career true shooting, 27th %tile among centers. Bottom fourth of centers in TS% past three seasons.

Possession Management: 3.34 TOV/36 ranks in the 2nd %tile when lower TOV rates are rewarded. Her AST/TOV ratio also ranks in bottom 10th %tile.

Availability: 69.2% career availability ranks in the 35th %tile but has shown improvement here past two seasons.

WHAT THE TREND MEANS

After injury-shortened 2023–24 seasons, Austin’s scoring peaked in the 86th–88th percentiles in 2024–25. Her 2026 impact is more balanced: rebounding (75th) and rim protection (69th) remain above average as scoring normalizes (53rd). Efficiency has improved from its 2024 low but remains below positional norms.

BEST ROLE AND LINEUP FIT

Paint-pressure finisher best paired with a high-assist guard and credible spacing. 58% of her attempts come at the rim and 72% of her makes are assisted. Her most-used 2025 lineup posted a +23.2 net rating across 346 possessions.

FORWARD EVALUATION / DECISION FRAME

ROLE TODAY Starter Responsibility: Austin has started all 21 appearances and averages 29.0 MPG, both ranking in the 81st percentile among centers. Interior Value: Her 11.3 REB/36 and 1.84 BLK/36 exceed the three-player top-quartile 2025 center benchmarks of 10.9 and 1.43. Role Boundary: Her 53.0% true shooting and 0.87 AST/TOV trail elite medians of 59.6% and 1.40, supporting a finisher/defender role rather than primary creation.	2-YEAR OUTLOOK Base Case: Starting/rotation center whose value continues to come from rebounding, rim protection and assisted interior finishing. Ceiling: Dependable two-way starter if finishing efficiency and possession management begin closing the gap to high-impact centers. Floor & Comparable Signal: Among ten age-and-role comparables, three maintained a 24+ MPG role two years later and one improved true shooting, making efficiency the primary development swing skill while availability remains the floor condition.	ROSTER RECOMMENDATION Decision – Retain & Support: Treat Austin as a complementary starting 5, not a primary offensive piece. Her rebounding, rim protection, and starter workload justify continued investment. Roster Construction: Prioritize guard creation and perimeter spacing, consistent with the construction of Washington’s best-performing high-minute Austin lineup in 2025. Risk Management: Maintain a credible backup center and role flexibility until Austin’s efficiency, ball security, and availability stabilize. Avoid relying on her as a consistent on-ball creator.
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WHAT WOULD CHANGE THE VIEW

UPSIDE TRIGGER Efficiency and decision-making move toward the center median - about 59% TS and 1.2–1.3 AST/TO - while Austin preserves her upper-tier rebounding, above-median rim protection, and current 80%+ availability.	DOWNSIDE TRIGGER Her role falls below approximately 24 MPG or availability drops below 80%, particularly if the current efficiency and turnover gaps persist or her rebounding and rim protection regress toward the position median.
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SOURCE NOTE DATA & CUTOFF: Public WNBA Stats and ESPN data accessed in R through wehoop 3.0.0; results through July 16, 2026. The 2026 season is partial. | **COHORTS & BENCHMARKS:** Career percentiles compare 24 listed centers with 500+ combined minutes and appearances in at least two seasons from 2022–26. Seasonal percentiles compare centers with 200+ minutes in that season; the 2026 cohort includes 18 centers. The high-impact benchmark represents three top-quartile 2025 centers by Player Impact Estimate from 11 qualified centers. | **COMPARABLES:** Two-year outcomes use ten unique age-and-role comparables drawn from 21 eligible player-seasons. Base seasons span 2016–23, with outcomes observed through 2025; results are descriptive and not forecasts.